POLICY

To ensure the health and well being of children within the early learning and child care setting for Emergency Child Care, children who become ill while attending the program will be immediately isolated and required to leave the program. Staff must consistently assess the health of children in care.

PROCEDURES

When to exclude

Child care employees should exclude a sick child when the child has any signs and/or symptoms of ill health **o**r if the child is unable to participate in regular programming because of illness.

Any child who develops symptoms of ill health including symptoms of ill health related to COVID-19 must leave the child care program.

Symptoms include

- Feeling feverish
- Coughing
- Runny nose
- Nasal congestion
- Difficulty breathing
- Vomiting
- Diarrhea
- Sore throat
- Hoarseness/difficulty swallowing
- Myalgia (body ache)

If the child has any symptoms (including fever, cough, difficulty breathing, vomiting, or diarrhea), the child must be isolated immediately from the other children in a separate room and supervised at all times.

The parent must be notified to arrange for pick-up of the child. If the parent is not reached an emergency contact person will be contacted to pick up the child.

Every effort must be made to keep the child comfortable until someone arrives to take him or her home.

Staff must document the situation in the Daily Communication Log and notify the Supervisor or designate immediately to ensure that this information is managed and recorded in the child's file on the Ill Health/Potential Allegation Record and report the incident to the Health Department, as necessary/appropriate.

How to exclude

- Supervise the child in a designated room with a hand washing sink or hand sanitizer available
- Notify parents/caregivers of the sick child for pick up
- Only one staff should be in the designated room and attempt physical distancing. If physical distancing cannot be avoided, staff should wear a mask and gloves. In addition, staff should perform hand hygiene and attempt to not touch their face with unwashed hands
- Increase ventilation in the designated exclusion room if possible (e.g., open windows)
- Clean and disinfect the area immediately after the child has been sent home
- The Health Department recommendations for staff and children who were in the same room with the ill child will be communicated to all staff and parent/caregivers and children in the group.
- Staff in the facility should self-monitor for symptoms for the next 14 days.
- If the symptomatic child tests negative for COVID-19 or is symptom free for 48 hrs and receives approval to return by a physician or Durham Health Department then all staff, parents/caregivers will be notified.

Returning from exclusion due to illness

- Staff/children who are being managed by Durham Public Health (e.g., confirmed cases of COVID-19, household contacts of cases) should follow instructions from Durham Health Department to determine when to return to the facility. Confirmation from Durham Health Department will be required.
- Child cannot return to program until symptom free for 48 hrs and clear by a physician or Durham Health Department.

Forms:

Ill Health/Potential Allegation Record
Routine Illness Surveillance Form for Community Settings